PREDICT — MARKET INTELLIGENCE

The Market Handbook

Every football market on football.com — decoded, settled, and mapped to the plays we actually make.

Compiled from a full study of the official football.com and SportyBet manuals and live market catalogues, 7 November 2026.

Know the market before the money moves.

Compiled 2026-11-07 by Phoenix (Predict agent) from a full end-to-end study: both official manuals read completely (football.com "How to Play — Football" and the SportyBet Nigeria football manual — the same document family, near word-for-word), plus a live market catalogue of Arsenal vs Hull City (Premier League, in-play) and a pre-match catalogue of Parma vs Bologna (Serie A). The source manuals are archived in `docs/manuals/`. This handbook is written in our own words from that study; where the manuals are silent, it says so.

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1. The five laws everything else obeys

1. **Regular time is the default universe.** Unless a market says otherwise, it is settled on the 90 minutes plus injury time. Extra time and penalty shootouts do not count.
2. **Goal time = when the ball crosses the line**, as announced by TV (else the match clock) — not when the shot was taken. Corner time = when the kick is taken. Booking time = when the card is shown. Offside/penalty time = when the referee decides.
3. **Statistics settle on Opta data** — shots, shots on target, fouls, offsides, tackles, saves, woodwork. Opta's definitions can differ from a league's own.
4. **Dead markets die.** If a match is interrupted and not finished within 48 hours of the original kickoff, undecided bets are void. Bets taken at a wrong displayed score, a wrong match clock (off by more than 5 minutes), or on an event that had already happened can be voided by the bookmaker.
5. **Pre-match and live are two different shops.** Whole market families exist on one side only (see §9). Anything involving minutes is a live-only product.

2. How to read a market name — the two numbers

Every time-based market carries **two different numbers doing two different jobs**:

- The **window** — in the market's title: `from 1 to 15`, `from 46 to 60`. This is minutes.
- The **line** — on the selection: `0.5`, `2.5`. In a goals market this counts **goals**, never minutes.

Read in full, "Under 0.5" inside a market titled `15 minutes - Over/Under from 1 to 15` means under 0.5 goals in minutes 1–15 — i.e. no goal in the first fifteen minutes. Confusing the window with the line is the single most expensive reading error on this site; this handbook exists because of it.

3. The early no-goal family — the owner's core plays

The play: neither team scores inside the opening window. Three windows matter: 5, 10, 15 minutes. Each has **two equivalent doors** on football.com, both **live-only** — they appear at kickoff and the opening window vanishes the moment it ends.

Play	Door A — interval 1st-goal market	Selection	Door B — interval totals market	Selection
No goal in first 5 min	`5 minutes - 1st goal from 1 to 5`	**None**	`5 minutes - Over/Under from 1 to 5`	**Under 0.5**
No goal in first 10 min	`10 minutes - 1st goal from 1 to 10`	**None**	`10 minutes - Over/Under from 1 to 10`	**Under 0.5**
		None		

Play	Door A — interval 1st-goal market	Selection	Door B — interval totals market	Selection
No goal in first 15 min	`15 minutes - 1st goal from 1 to 15`		`15 minutes - Over/Under from 1 to 15`	**Under 0.5**

How each door works:

- **Door A ("…minutes - 1st goal from a to b")** offers Home / **None** / Away: which team scores the first goal inside that window — or nobody (**None**). The manual's one-line definition covers the Nth-goal interval family ("predict which team will score the Nth goal within a time interval"); the None option itself is never defined in either manual — its meaning is fixed by the market's structure, and it is confirmed by live prices (the None price in a window matches the Under 0.5 price for the same window, e.g. both 1.27 for minutes 41–50 on Arsenal vs Hull).
- **Door B ("…minutes - Over/Under from a to b")** is the same bet in totals language: the manual defines it as the total goals inside a 5/10/15-minute interval measured against a line, and the 0.5 line can only mean zero goals (see §4). In the observed live pages, 0.5 was the only line offered in these interval totals.
- A near neighbour that is **not** the same bet: `…minutes - 1X2 from a to b` → **Draw**. A level window includes 1–1 inside the window; the owner's play loses on any goal. Use Doors A/B for the pure play.

Operating facts (verified live):

- The windows **roll**. Only the current block is listed: at half-time of Arsenal vs Hull the 15-minute 1X2 showed `from 46 to 60`, the 5-minute showed `from 46 to 50`, and the 10-minute 1st-goal showed `from 41 to 50`. At kickoff they read `from 1 to 5 / 1 to 10 / 1 to 15`.
- The 10-minute 1X2 is a different animal: one market named `1X2 - Intervals of 10 Minutes` whose row is cumulative ("1 to 50 Minutes", then "1 to 60 Minutes") — the 1X2 of the whole score from minute 1 to the next 10-minute boundary. It is not a set of slices.
- There are also cumulative totals, live only: `Total Goals Over/Under from 1 to X minute` (X = 50, 55, … 85 in repeated groups; the first group was verified as the 0.5 line — "no goal at all by minute X" is Under 0.5 there).
- **League/feed dependence:** minute markets are not universal. A live Botola Pro match observed the same day (Kawkab vs Wydad) had an empty Minutes tab and no interval markets at all. Always confirm the family exists on the specific match before planning a play.
- Pre-match, the Minutes tab holds exactly **two** markets: the first-goal interval markets of §5. Nothing else. Any plan that needs a window market is a live-betting plan.

Measured base rates (our research, for calibration): across big-league football, roughly 93% of matches are goalless at 5′, ~81% at 10′, ~69–71% at 15′ — before adjusting for the two teams' expected goals. The Predict engine prices each match individually (`src/predict_agent/early_goals.py`: P(no goal by t) = exp(−λ_match × F(t)) with the empirical goal-timing curve F(5)=0.032, F(10)=0.072, F(15)=0.128).

4. Over/Under — the lines, settled

The manual's definition, paraphrased: predict whether the total goals in regular time finish over or under a given line. Lines come in three kinds, and the kind decides the settlement:

Line kind	Examples	Possible settlements
Half lines	0.5, 1.5, 2.5, 3.5	Win or lose only — no refunds
Whole lines	1, 2, 3	Win, lose, or **void** (stake back) if the total lands exactly on the line
Quarter lines	0.75, 1.25, 2.25, 2.75	The stake splits across the two neighbouring lines: win, lose, half-win, or half-lose

Worked rows from the manual's settlement table (totals in regular time):

- **0.5** — Over wins at 1+ goals; **Under wins only at 0 goals.** Under 0.5 on a full match is a bet on 0–0.
- **2.0** — exactly 2 goals = void; 3+ Over; 0–1 Under.
- **2.25** — exactly 2 goals: Over loses half, Under wins half; 3+ Over; 0–1 Under.
- **2.5** — 3+ Over; 0–2 Under.
- **2.75** — exactly 3: Over wins half, Under loses half; 4+ Over; 0–2 Under.
- **3.0** — exactly 3 = void; 4+ Over; 0–2 Under.

The same line logic applies inside any scope the market names: full match, one team (Home/Away Team Over/Under), one half, or one interval window (§3, Door B). Scope is always in the market title; the line is always the count.

5. The two "None"s — and the first-goal timing markets

The word **None** appears as a selection in two unrelated places, and confusing them is expensive:

Where you see "None"	What it means	Settles
Interval 1st-goal markets — `…minutes - 1st goal from a to b` (Home / None / Away)	**No goal inside that window**	When the window ends
`When will the 1st goal be scored (15 min interval)` / `(10 min interval)` — options 1-15, 16-30, …, 76-90, None	**No goal in the entire match** (0–0 full time)	Full time

`When will the 1st goal be scored` is the **only** early-timing market sold **pre-match** (Minutes tab). Its options are windows in which a goal is scored — the opposite direction from the owner's play — plus None for a goalless match. Live, the elapsed windows show as locked while the rest keep pricing. Observed pre-match (Parma vs Bologna): 15-min version — 1-15 @3.40, 16-30 @4.20, 31-45 @5.10, 46-60 @8.40, 61-75 @12.00, 76-90 @14.00, None @9.70; 10-min version — 1-10 @4.90 stepping to 81-90 @19.50, None @9.60.

Neither manual defines this market family beyond a single line for the 10-minute Nth-goal version ("predict at which time interval (10 mins) the Nth goal will be scored"), and neither manual contains the word "None" at all. The meanings above are fixed by market structure and were verified against live pricing behaviour (the whole-match None shortened from 32.00 pre-match to ~6.50 at half-time of a 0–0 match — exactly how a 0–0-full-time price behaves).

Related goal-timing markets:

- **1st Goal** (Main tab): Home / None / Away — which side scores the match's first goal, or nobody. The manual has no heading for this market; the site's separate **Next Goal** rule states that if the named goal is never scored, those bets are void — a different treatment from a None selection, so do not blend the two in your head.

- **Next Goal / Last Goal:** which team scores the Nth / the last goal of the match.
- **Next Scoring Type:** the kind of the next goal — free kick, penalty, header, own goal, other, or No Goal.

6. The core result markets

Market	Meaning	Settlement notes
1X2	Home win / Draw / Away win in regular time	The base market. Variants below change when it settles
1X2 — 1UP	Your team is paid as a winner the moment it leads by 1 goal	Once settled, the final score is irrelevant. Draw selections settle like normal 1X2
1X2 — 2UP	Paid as a winner the moment your team leads by 2 goals	Same early-settlement logic; still paid if the match is later abandoned with the 2-goal lead
1X2 — NeverDown	Your team must win **without ever trailing**	Going behind at any point loses the bet, even in a comeback win. football.com also sells team versions (Home/Away 1UP, 2UP, 3UP) and Double Chance 1UP
DrawSave (football.com)	The **Draw** selection wins if the score is level at the 90th minute — and still wins on any full-time draw	Singles and multiples only; if your team led by 1+ the draw option stays "live" only until the 60th minute per the manual text
Double Chance	1X (home or draw), 12 (either team wins), X2 (draw or away)	Two of the three outcomes in one selection
Draw No Bet	Pick the winner; a draw voids the bet	Stake refunded on a draw
Home No Bet / Away No Bet	Pick the result; if the named side wins, the bet voids	Mirror-image insurance markets
European Handicap (3-way)	A goal start (+/−) is added to a team's score, then 1X2 is settled on the adjusted score	Three outcomes, no refunds; the handicap is part of the score
Asian Handicap	Handicap with split lines (0, ±0.25, ±0.5, ±0.75, ±1…)	Draws can refund (line 0), half-refund (quarter lines). E.g. −0.25: win by 1+ = full win, draw = half stake back, lose = full loss
Correct Score	The exact full-time score	Usually a 8–16% shot even for the likeliest line — price accordingly
Half Time / Full Time	The result at half-time **and** at full-time, as one selection (e.g. Draw/Home)	Only the HT/FT Correct Score variant exists pre-match on football.com; there is no plain HT/FT 1X2 there
GG/NG (Both Teams To Score)	Yes = both teams score at least once; No = at least one team fails to score	Also GG/NG 2+ (both score 2+), and 1st-half versions
Exact Goals	The exact total number of goals (0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5+)	Live Main tab on football.com; also per-team and per-half

Market	Meaning	Settlement notes
Odd/Even	Total goals odd or even — **zero goals counts as even**	Per match, per team, per half
Goal Range / Goal Bounds	Total goals fall inside a chosen band (e.g. 1–2, 2–4, 0–3)	"Excluded Number of Goals" is the inverse idea: total minus a chosen number
Winning Margin	The exact goal difference between the teams	Sign matters: home by 2 ≠ away by 2
Teams to Score / Clean Sheet	Which teams score; which teams keep a clean sheet	Team-level building blocks used by many combos
Win to Nil	A team wins **and** concedes nothing	Manual spelling: "Win to Nill"

7. Halves

Every core idea repeats per half, and a half is settled **only on goals within that half** (the second half starts 0–0 for betting purposes):

- 1st Half / 2nd Half versions of: 1X2, Double Chance, Draw No Bet, Handicap, Asian Handicap, Over/Under, GG/NG, Correct Score, team totals, exact goals, odd/even, clean sheets.
- **Which Team Will Win the Rest (of the half/match):** from the moment of betting, only goals scored after that moment count — the score effectively restarts at 0–0.
- **Highest Scoring Half:** which half produces more goals (1st / 2nd / equal), also per team.
- **Win Both Halves / Win Either Half:** a team must outscore the opponent in both halves, or in at least one.

8. Corners and bookings

Corners settle on corners **taken** — awarded-but-not-taken corners do not count, and a re-taken corner counts once. Markets: total Corners Over/Under, Corners 1X2 (which team takes more), per-team totals, Corner Handicap, Corner Range, Nth Corner, Last Corner, Race to X Corners, odd/even — plus half and 5/10/15-minute interval versions of the same ideas.

Bookings counting, from the manual: a yellow card = **1 card**, a red or second-yellow red = **2 cards**; the second yellow itself is not double-counted, so one player can cause at most **3 cards**. Booking points: yellow = **10**, red = **25**, one player max **35**. Cards shown after the final whistle, and cards for non-players (bench, manager, substituted players), do not count; a card shown during the half-time break counts in the second half. Markets: Total Bookings (cards) Over/Under, Booking Points Over/Under, Bookings 1X2, 1st Booking (Home / None / Away), Exact Bookings, Sending Off (per team too), booking handicaps — plus half and interval versions.

9. Player markets

All player markets settle on **Opta** definitions (a "shot on target" includes a goal-line or woodwork contact per Opta; a shot blocked by another outfield player is not a shot at all, and so on).

- **Participation rule:** if the player takes any part in the match, the bet stands — starter or substitute, however few minutes.

- **No-show rule:** if the player never enters, bets void — **except** a named list that voids if the player merely does not **start**: player shots, shots on goal, assists, tackles, passes, player-not-to-score, and player head-to-heads.
- **Goalscorer markets:** First / Anytime / Last goalscorer; to score 2+; score-or-assist; score-and-assist; method markets (header, free kick, foot). **Own goals never count** for Anytime or score-X markets — but an own goal **does** count as the First Goal for First Goalscorer settlement. If a match ends goalless, First Goalscorer player bets lose (the market's own "no goal" outcome is the winner).
- **Performance lines:** shots, shots on target (incl. from outside the box, per half, each half), passes, tackles, fouls, offsides, to be carded, first player booked.

10. Football.com's EarlyWin family (pre-match only)

A whole tab that exists **only before kickoff** on football.com (not in the SportyBet manual):

- **1X2 (1UP) / 1X2 (2UP)** and **Double Chance (1UP)** — as §6.
- **Over/Under (GoalRush):** you bet **Over only**; the bet is paid immediately if the goals arrive early on a fixed ladder (per the manual's EarlyGoals definition: Over 1.5 needs 1 goal by 10′, Over 2.5 needs 2 by 30′, Over 3.5 needs 3 by 50′). If the early condition fails, the selection is **not lost** — it reverts to being a normal Over/Under bet for the full match.
- **Home/Away Over/Under (Early Goals)** and **(GoalRush)** — the same idea scoped to one team.
- **To Lead by 1 / 2 / 3 Goals at Any Time** — the team reaches that lead at any point.

11. Combination markets

The site builds two-leg ideas into single selections. The recurring grammar: **"A or B"** wins if either leg lands; **"A & B"** needs both.

- **1X2 & Over/Under**, **1X2 & GG/NG**, **Double Chance & Over/Under**, **Double Chance & GG/NG**, **Over/Under & GG/NG**, **HT/FT & Over/Under** — the paired markets, both legs must land (& versions).
- **Home/Draw/Away Team or …** — e.g. "Home Team or Over 2.5", "Draw or GG/NG", "Away Team or Any Clean Sheet": wins if the result leg or the goals leg lands.

12. Live vs pre-match — the map that matters

Observed on the same day: a live Premier League match showing **241 markets** (falling as windows settle) and a pre-match Serie A match showing **881** (every line variant counted). Named blocks: ~130 live, ~142 pre-match — but the families differ:

Live only	Pre-match only
All rolling interval markets (1X2, 1st goal, Over/Under at 5/10/15 min)	The entire **EarlyWin** tab (1UP/2UP/DrawSave/GoalRush/EarlyGoals)
Cumulative totals "from 1 to X minute"	1st Booking, Exact Bookings
Rest of the Match, Win From Behind	Goal in Both Halves, Goal Bounds, Excluded Number of Goals
Exact Goals, Odd/Even (match), Home/Away No Bet	

Live only	Pre-match only
	Full player-prop depth (assists, passes, tackles, not-to-score…)
Fouls markets (Fouls 1X2, Fouls Over/Under, team fouls)	Team posts/crossbars, team offsides, substitution markets
2nd-half market set (grows as the match ages)	1st-half everything (dies at half-time)

Both sides share: 1X2 and variants, all Over/Under lines, Double Chance, handicaps, GG/NG, correct score, team totals, corners and bookings cores, goalscorer markets, and the Minutes tab's two first-goal interval markets.

13. Traps this handbook now guards against

1. **The two Nones** (§5). Always name the market, not just the selection.
2. **Window ≠ line** (§2). Minutes live in titles; 0.5 counts goals.
3. **"It doesn't exist" is a live-vs-pre-match claim.** The early no-goal family is invisible until kickoff. No market is declared absent until the live list has been checked.
4. **Padlocks are normal.** Markets suspend briefly around goals, dangerous attacks and half-time, and settled windows lock/disappear. A locked market is not a broken site.
5. **The manuals have gaps and typos.** "None" is defined nowhere; the 15-minute first-goal market has no manual heading; football.com's manual mis-defines "Draw or GG/NG" (copied from the Home Team version) and repeats 1UP text inside its EarlyGoals section. When the manual and the market's own structure disagree, structure and observed settlement win.
6. **Feed dependence.** Lower-league matches may carry no minute markets at all (§3). Check the specific match, every time.

14. Our staking protocol (standing)

1. The model chooses the play by **percentage** — never by the bookmaker's price.
2. Before any stake, the exact **market name + selection + settlement** is stated and matched against this handbook (e.g. 15 minutes - 1st goal from 1 to 15 → None; settles at 15:00).
3. Stakes are singles, at the owner's exact amounts, on football.com only, unless the owner rules otherwise for that bet.
4. Every result — right or wrong — is settled into the Predict ledger and graded the next morning; the ratings learn from all of it.

Sources: football.com How to Play — Football & General Settlement pages; SportyBet Nigeria How to Play — Football & General pages (both archived in `docs/manuals/`); live and pre-match market catalogues captured 2026-11-07 on football.com/ng. Prices quoted in this handbook are observations from that day, not standing odds.